Before you begin

Fitness: my story and my diary

Two parts to work on before your cohort begins: your story, and a daily diary. Print these pages, or copy the questions into a notebook that you keep for the whole programme. Write as much or as little as you like. Nothing needs to be shared.

Part 1: My story

1. What are your earliest memories of moving your body: sport, play, dance, walking? How did it feel?

2. When did being active become harder, or stop? What was happening in your life at the time?

3. How has your relationship with exercise and your body changed over the years?

4. What have you tried before to get fitter, and what did you learn from it? What worked, even for a while?

5. What gets in the way of moving now: time, energy, motivation, how you feel about your body, something else?

6. What has brought you to this group, now?

7. Who are you becoming? Describe yourself as someone who moves every day.

Part 2: My diary

Keep this diary every day until the cohort begins, and keep going as you go through the programme. You don't need to change anything yet: just notice. Write one line for each time you moved, and for long stretches of sitting.

Day 1 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

8. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

9. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

10. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

11. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 2 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

12. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

13. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

14. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

15. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 3 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

16. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

17. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

18. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

19. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 4 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

20. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

21. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

22. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

23. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 5 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

24. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

25. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

26. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

27. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 6 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

28. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

29. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

30. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

31. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Day 7 Date: _____

Time	What I did (or sitting)	How long	Alone, or with whom?	Energy and mood before, then after

32. How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?

33. What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?

34. When did I feel most like moving? When least? Alone or with others, morning or evening?

35. How did I feel in my body today, and about my body? What emotions came up around exercise?

Need more days? Print the diary pages again, or carry on in your notebook.